Knitting Abbreviations

The short forms you will meet in most knitting patterns, written in US terms.

FREE PRINTABLE
STITCH SCROLL

ABBR.	MEANS
alt	alternate
approx	approximately
beg	beginning
BO	bind off
CC	contrasting color
cn	cable needle
CO	cast on
cont	continue
dec	decrease
dpn	double-pointed needles
foll	following
g st	garter stitch
inc	increase
k	knit
k1tbl	knit 1 through the back loop
k2tog	knit 2 together (leans right)
kfb	knit into the front and back of a stitch (adds 1)
kwise	knitwise
LH	left hand
M1	make 1 (adds 1)
M1L	make 1 left (leans left)
M1R	make 1 right (leans right)
MB	make bobble
MC	main color
p	purl
p2tog	purl 2 together
pat or patt	pattern

ABBR.	MEANS
pfb	purl into the front and back of a stitch
pm	place marker
psso	pass slipped stitch over
pwise	purlwise
rem	remaining
rep	repeat
rev St st	reverse stockinette stitch
RH	right hand
rnd	round
RS	right side
sk2p	slip 1, knit 2 together, pass the slipped stitch over
skp	slip 1, knit 1, pass the slipped stitch over
sl	slip
sl1k / sl1p	slip 1 knitwise / slip 1 purlwise
sm	slip marker
ssk	slip, slip, knit: slip 2 stitches knitwise, one at a time, then knit them together through the back loops (leans left)
ssp	slip, slip, purl: slip 2 stitches knitwise, put them back on the left needle, then purl them together through the back loops (leans left)
st(s)	stitch(es)
St st	stockinette stitch
tbl	through the back loop
tog	together
w&t	wrap and turn
WS	wrong side
wyib	with yarn in back
wyif	with yarn in front
yo	yarn over (adds 1)

Same thing, different words

US PATTERN	OTHER PATTERNS
bind off (BO)	**cast off (UK)**
stockinette stitch (St st)	**stocking stitch (UK)**
gauge	**tension (UK and Canada)**
yarn over (yo)	**yfwd, yon or yrn**

Symbols in patterns

*	repeat the steps that come after the * as the pattern tells you
[ ]	work the steps inside the brackets as many times as the pattern says

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